



Figure 3: How Firewall Builder works

a firewall rule.

- Easy search facility to find where objects have been used.
- Configuration versioning – this is a facility to automatically roll back on the previous firewall configuration.
- Pre-defined templates for firewall rules and familiar deployment scenarios.
- Start-up scripts – pre- and post-firewall scripts.

Supported platforms

Firewall Builder supports policy configuration and management on Linux iptables, Cisco ASA/PIX, Cisco Firewall Service Module (FWSM), Cisco router access control lists (ACL), OpenBSD *pf*, HP ProCurve ACL, FreeBSD *ipfw* and *ipfilter*.

Firewall and Cloud Computing

Scenario: For an e-commerce application, secure one or multiple public-facing Web servers. Regardless of whether that server is situated in DMZ, Amazon's Cloud, Rackspace Cloud, or in Private Cloud, it requires the same level of risk management. Considering this factor, it may not be important where the Web server is hosted. A single firewall policy for Web Server and Database Server can be enforced. Hierarchical policies can be made and enforced as per your convenience to make the application more secure.

In this situation, the easiest implementation is to leverage the firewall built into each operating system. If we define the organisation's rules within the host-based firewall as per policies, the risk mitigation policy is not dependent on the logical location, and hence it can scale as required. All we need is a good tool for managing the built-in firewall without complexities.

How to install Firewall Builder in a Cloud environment

In Private Cloud, Firewall Builder can be installed in various operating systems and be used according to the environment or the access to the virtual machine that cloud service

providers allow.

For Red Hat, Fedora, OpenSUSE, and others, download and install the Firewall Builder RPM, e.g., *fwbuilder-5.1.0.3599-1.el5.i386.rpm*

You need to install *libxml2 v2.4.10* or newer, *libxslt v1.0.7* or newer, *ucd-snmp* or *net-snmp*, and *QT 4.3.x, 4.4.x, 4.5.x, 4.6.x* to satisfy dependencies.

Navigate to your download directory and execute the following:

```
rpm -i fwbuilder-5.1.0.3599-1.el5.i386.rpm
```

For Ubuntu, download and install the Firewall Builder package, e.g., *fwbuilder_5.1.0.3599-ubuntu-precise-1_i386.deb*

You need to install *QT 4.3.x, 4.4.x, 4.5.x, and 4.6.x* to satisfy dependencies.

Navigate to your download directory and execute the following:

```
dpkg -i fwbuilder_5.1.0.3599-ubuntu-precise-1_i386.deb
```

For a Windows installation, double-click the *Download fwbuilder-5.1.0.3599.exe (18.0 MB)* link, then follow the step-by-step instructions in the installation wizard.

Figure 3 shows how Firewall Builder works.

Firewall Builder vs UFW

	Firewall Builder	Uncomplicated firewall (UFW)
Website	http://www.fwbuilder.org/	https://launchpad.net/u fw
License	GNU General Public License	GNU General Public License
Interface	GUI	Command Line
Stable release	0.33	5

Now that you know what Firewall Builder is all about, go ahead and use it to protect yourself and your organisation from unwanted intrusions. 

References

- [1] <http://www.fwbuilder.org/>
- [2] <http://searchsecurity.techtarget.com/definition/Firewall-Builders>

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